

MWRCNN: A MULTI-STAGE WAVELET-BASED DYNAMIC CONVOLUTION NETWORK FOR GENERAL IMAGE RESTORATION

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ABSTRACT

Deep learning, particularly convolutional neural networks (CNNs), achieves superior image denoising compared with traditional model-based approaches. However, many CNN denoisers obtain accuracy gains by increasing network depth, which raises computational cost and can hinder generalization. The Multi-stage Wavelet-based Dynamic Convolutional Neural Network (MWDCNN) addresses this trade-off by integrating dynamic convolution with wavelet transforms to balance performance and efficiency. In this work, we extend MWDCNN from a single-task denoising network to a multi-task image restoration framework, MWRCNN (Multi-stage Wavelet-based Restoration CNN). MWRCNN generalizes the original architecture to handle deblurring, JPEG artifact removal, and super-resolution while retaining the multi-stage structure and wavelet-based frequency analysis. We focus on the Dynamic Convolutional Block (DCB) and its Weight Generator (WG), which produces input-adaptive convolution kernels. We analyze limitations of the current lightweight WG design—namely its tendency to oversimplify spatial information—and propose strategies that preserve richer spatial context without sacrificing computational efficiency. Our goal is to improve both adaptability and overall restoration quality of MWRCNN across diverse low-level vision tasks. You can find the code: <https://github.com/linxin0/253>

Index Terms— image restoration, image denoising, super-resolution, wavelet transform, dynamic convolution

1. INTRODUCTION

Image restoration is a fundamental task in computer vision that focuses on recovering a clean image from observations degraded during acquisition or by adverse conditions. It encompasses low-level vision problems such as image denoising, image deblurring, super-resolution, and JPEG artifact removal. Restoration not only improves human visual quality but also benefits downstream high-level tasks, including image segmentation, object detection, and 3D reconstruction.

We first use the denoising task to introduce background and motivation. Early methods such as BM3D [1] and WNNM [2] exploit statistical regularities in images. These

model-based approaches typically assume that patches exhibit redundancy or low-rank structure, which can be captured via non-local self-similarity and sparse modeling. BM3D performs collaborative filtering in a 3D transform domain by grouping similar patches and jointly denoising them, while WNNM improves detail preservation by modeling grouped patches as low-rank matrices and applying weighted nuclear norm minimization. Although these methods are effective for simple noise models, their performance often depends on prior assumptions and hand-tuned parameters, limiting robustness to complex real-world noise.

With the advent of learning-based approaches, representative supervised methods [3, 4, 5] leverage strong feature representations and end-to-end optimization to learn mappings from noisy to clean images directly from data, without hand-crafted priors. Owing to their superior denoising accuracy, generalization across noise levels and domains, and adaptability, such approaches have been widely applied to denoising, deblurring, and super-resolution, often surpassing traditional algorithms.

However, many learning-based methods emphasize spatial-domain features while underutilizing frequency-domain information, which can lead to suboptimal recovery of fine textures and reduced robustness under complex noise. Two complementary directions have gained attention. The first augments CNNs with classical signal-processing tools such as the wavelet transform, which decomposes images into multi-resolution representations to expose both global structures and local details. The second employs dynamic convolution: instead of fixed filters, the network uses an attention-like mechanism to adapt kernel parameters to the input, enhancing flexibility and representational power.

We build on the MWDCNN framework [6], which comprises a Dynamic Convolutional Block (DCB) that adapts to input features, two Wavelet Transform and Enhancement Blocks (WEBs) that extract frequency cues via wavelet transforms, and a Residual Block (RB) that refines and reconstructs images using enhanced residual-dense architectures [7]. Originally designed for denoising, MWDCNN is generalized here into MWRCNN (Multi-stage Wavelet-based Restoration CNN) to handle a broader set of restoration tasks, including deblurring, JPEG artifact removal, and

super-resolution, while retaining its multi-stage structure and wavelet-based analysis. In the first stage of MWDCNN, the DCB involves a trade-off between performance and efficiency. The Weight Generator (WG) that produces dynamic kernel weights currently relies on global average pooling followed by 1×1 convolutions, which may discard spatial context. In this work, we analyze the DCB—especially the WG design—and evaluate strategies that preserve richer spatial information while keeping computational cost reasonable.

2. RELATED WORK

2.1. Deep Learning for Image Restoration

Deep Convolutional Neural Networks (CNNs) have been proposed to overcome the drawbacks of traditional machine learning techniques in various image restoration tasks.

For image denoising, these methods learn an end-to-end mapping from a noisy image to a clean one. To accelerate the training speed, Zhang et al. utilized patches of noisy images and noisy mappings to train an efficient denoising network [3]. Subsequent efforts to improve denoising performance have incorporated components such as dilated convolutions and batch normalization (BN) within the CNN, allowing the model to obtain more accurate context information and thus promote the denoising effect [8].

This deep-learning paradigm has also advanced other restoration tasks. In single-image super-resolution (SR), the goal is to recover high-resolution detail from a low-resolution image. Early methods such as SRCNN established an end-to-end mapping, while later approaches, including EDSR and Residual Dense Networks (RDN), employed deeper residual architectures; the use of residual dense blocks is likewise central to the MWDCNN design. For image deblurring, CNNs learn the nonlinear mapping from blurred to sharp imagery, often exploiting multi-scale or recurrent structures to cope with spatially varying motion blur and unknown kernels. Finally, in JPEG artifact removal, architectures originally developed for denoising (e.g., DnCNN) have proved effective at suppressing blocking and ringing artifacts, underscoring the shared structure across low-level vision problems and the applicability of similar deep-learning principles.

2.2. Convolution Layer Arrangements on Dynamic Processing

There is a work states that significant limitation of conventional Convolutional Neural Networks (CNNs) is their reliance on static parameters. In a standard convolutional layer, the filter weights are fixed and shared across all inputs after the training phase is complete. This paradigm, while effective for general feature extraction, lacks the adaptability to adjust its parameters based on the specific characteristics of different input images. Consequently, this rigidity can hinder

the network’s ability to achieve a robust performance when faced with diverse visual data.

To address this ‘one-size-fits-all’ limitation, the concept of dynamic convolutions was introduced [9]. Instead of employing a single, static convolutional kernel, this approach utilizes multiple (K) parallel convolutional kernels within the same layer. These kernels are then dynamically aggregated based on the input, using an attention mechanism to compute K individual weights. The final, effective convolutional kernel for that specific input is the weighted sum of these K parallel kernels.

This input-dependent aggregation allows the network to “dynamically adjust parameters” for each image, yielding a more robust and representationally powerful classifier. Critically, this is achieved while mitigating the severe computational costs that would be incurred by simply increasing the depth or width of a static network [10].

The approach has been validated across a range of image applications. Dynamic modules have been integrated into CNNs to identify and discard redundant features, improving training efficiency and classification accuracy. The core idea further extends beyond convolution: Sun et al. proposed Gaussian dynamic pyramid pooling to mine richer context and strengthen segmentation networks via dynamic weighting [11]. Efficiency optimizations have also been explored: Li et al. showed that matrix decomposition within dynamic kernel generation can deliver a better performance–speed trade-off for recognition tasks [12]. Motivated by these results, the present work integrates dynamic convolution into the proposed denoising architecture, leveraging its adaptability while controlling computational overhead.

2.3. Wavelet Transform Methods

The application of signal processing techniques to low-level vision tasks is well-established, predicated on the fundamental principle that images can be effectively modeled and processed as signals. Among these techniques, the wavelet transform has proven particularly effective. Its ability to decompose an image into a multi-resolution representation, separating high-frequency (detail) components from low-frequency (approximation) components, makes it an invaluable tool for tasks where fine-grained detail and structural information are paramount.

The efficacy of wavelet transform in image processing, particularly for denoising, has been demonstrated through various approaches. For instance, early methods leveraged its statistical properties; Cho et al. employed a multivariate statistical modeling approach to estimate wavelet coefficients, thereby filtering noise from the signal-in-the-wavelet domain [13]. Other research has explored hybrid methodologies, such as the work by Liu et al., which combined the wavelet transform with a genetic algorithm to effectively suppress noise in corrupted images [14].

More recently, a significant trend has emerged in fusing the traditional signal processing power of wavelet transform with the advanced feature-learning capabilities of deep learning, especially Convolutional Neural Networks (CNNs). This hybrid paradigm seeks to gain the 'best of both worlds'. For example, in the domain of image super-resolution, researchers have integrated wavelet transform into a CNN to explicitly learn detailed information (from high-frequency sub-bands) and content information (from the low-frequency sub-band). Along similar lines, Yang and Wang et al. [15] proposed an alternative architecture that integrates CNNs and wavelet transform using cross-connections and residual techniques, further validating this fusion strategy for image super-resolution.

This powerful combination of wavelets and deep learning goes beyond just denoising and super-resolution. It shows its usefulness in various image restoration tasks mentioned in our introduction.

- For image deblurring, the wavelet transform can isolate high-frequency components. This lets a network concentrate on restoring sharp edges and fine textures that the blurring process has softened.
- In the case of restoring images affected by JPEG compression, the transform excels at identifying and separating compression artifacts. Blocky and ringing artifacts appear as unnatural grid-like patterns in certain high-frequency wavelet sub-bands. This makes it easier for a CNN to target and eliminate them.

We can determine that these collected works illustrate a clear precedent: the wavelet transform is a highly effective and flexible tool for low-level vision tasks. Inspired by this body of research, and particularly by the success of fusing frequency-domain analysis with spatial deep learning, our proposed method incorporates two cascaded wavelet transform techniques into a CNN. This design aims to implement a robust fusion of frequency information and structural information, thereby promoting superior visual denoising effects.

3. DATA CONSTRUCTION BACKGROUND

We adopt the clean image dataset from Xu *et al.* [16] as our base pristine set. The original dataset contains a large number of high-quality, real-world photographs captured under diverse lighting and scene conditions. To construct our training data, we crop the original high-resolution images into smaller non-overlapping patches and finally obtain 3,859 clean color images, forming our *pristine_images_color* dataset. These cropped images serve as the ground truth for generating degraded versions under different degradation models.

For evaluation, we use the widely adopted BSD68 [17] dataset, which contains 68 natural images commonly used

as a benchmark for image restoration tasks. Both the training and testing datasets are subjected to multiple degradation schemes, including Gaussian noise addition, Gaussian blur, JPEG compression, bicubic downsampling (for super-resolution), mixed degradation, and low light degraded as detailed in the following sections.

In our evaluation, we compare two representative restoration approaches across all degradation types:

- **Traditional method: Total Variation (TV) regularization.** TV solves the general inverse problem

$$\hat{\mathbf{x}} = \arg \min_{\mathbf{x}} \frac{1}{2} \|\mathbf{y} - \mathbf{H}\mathbf{x}\|_2^2 + \lambda \|\nabla \mathbf{x}\|_1,$$

where $\mathbf{H}$ is the degradation operator corresponding to each task. TV is widely recognized as a baseline method applicable to denoising, deblurring, compression artifact reduction, super-resolution, and low-light enhancement.

- **Learning-based method: MWRCNN.** MWRCNN represents the deep-learning based approach and serves as the main model of interest in this project.

Below we describe the synthetic degradation models used for generating corrupted observations.

3.1. Image Denoising Background

In real-world imaging systems, images are often corrupted by various types of noise during acquisition, transmission, or storage. The degradation process can be generally modeled as:

$$\mathbf{y} = \mathbf{x} + \mathbf{n}, \quad (1)$$

where $\mathbf{y}$ denotes the observed noisy image, $\mathbf{x}$ is the unknown clean image, and $\mathbf{n}$ represents the noise component. In many practical cases, $\mathbf{n}$ can be approximated by additive white Gaussian noise (AWGN), i.e., $\mathbf{n} \sim \mathcal{N}(0, \sigma^2)$, where σ controls the noise intensity.

In our experiments, we simulate this degradation process by adding Gaussian noise with mean 0 and variance $\sigma^2 = 25^2/50^2$ to each pixel of the clean images, following the code implementation below:

$$\mathbf{y}(i, j, c) = \mathbf{x}(i, j, c) + \mathcal{N}(0, \sigma^2), \quad (2)$$

where (i, j) denotes the spatial position and $c \in \{R, G, B\}$ indicates the color channel. The resulting pixel values are then clipped to the valid intensity range $[0, 255]$.

For the denoising task under this degradation model, we will compare the TV-regularized reconstruction against MWRCNN, treating them as the traditional and learning-based baselines, respectively.

3.2. Image Deblurring Background

Image blurring is another common degradation in image restoration tasks, which often occurs due to camera motion, defocus, or atmospheric turbulence during the image acquisition process. The degradation process of a blurred image can be mathematically modeled as a convolution between the clean image and a blur kernel, followed by possible noise contamination:

$$\mathbf{y} = \mathbf{k} * \mathbf{x} + \mathbf{n}, \quad (3)$$

where $\mathbf{y}$ denotes the observed blurred image, $\mathbf{x}$ is the latent sharp image, $\mathbf{k}$ represents the blur kernel (also referred to as the point spread function, PSF), $*$ denotes the convolution operator, and $\mathbf{n}$ is additive noise.

In our experiments, we simulate the blurring process by applying a Gaussian blur to each clean image, using a kernel of size 7×7 and a standard deviation $\sigma = 1.5$, consistent with the implementation below:

$$\mathbf{y}(i, j, c) = (\mathbf{k}_{\text{Gaussian}} * \mathbf{x})(i, j, c), \quad (4)$$

where $\mathbf{k}_{\text{Gaussian}}$ is a normalized Gaussian kernel, (i, j) indicates the spatial position, and $c \in \{R, G, B\}$ is the color channel. The Gaussian blur operation smooths local intensity variations and removes high-frequency details, effectively simulating common real-world blur effects caused by slight defocus or motion.

For this degradation, we will evaluate both TV-based restoration and MWRCNN.

3.3. JPEG Compression Restoration Background

JPEG compression is one of the most widely used image storage formats due to its high compression ratio and efficiency. However, heavy compression inevitably introduces visible artifacts, such as blocking effects, ringing, and loss of fine details, which significantly degrade the perceptual quality of images. The degradation process of JPEG compression can be described as a quantization operation in the frequency domain:

$$\mathbf{y} = \mathcal{Q}(\mathcal{DCT}(\mathbf{x})), \quad (5)$$

where $\mathbf{x}$ is the original clean image, $\mathcal{DCT}(\cdot)$ denotes the block-wise discrete cosine transform (DCT), and $\mathcal{Q}(\cdot)$ represents the quantization process applied to DCT coefficients. The quantization step is controlled by a quality factor $Q \in [1, 100]$, where a smaller Q leads to stronger compression and more severe artifacts.

In our experiments, we simulate this degradation by saving each image in JPEG format with a compression quality factor of $Q = 10$, following the implementation below:

$$\mathbf{y}_{\text{JPEG}} = \mathcal{Q}_{Q=10}(\mathcal{DCT}(\mathbf{x})), \quad (6)$$

which corresponds to a strong compression setting that introduces notable blocking and texture loss. The goal of JPEG compression artifact reduction is to recover a visually pleasing and high-fidelity image $\hat{\mathbf{x}}$ from the compressed image $\mathbf{y}_{\text{JPEG}}$ by reducing quantization errors and restoring lost high-frequency information.

3.4. Image Super-Resolution Background

Image super-resolution (SR) aims to reconstruct a high-resolution (HR) image from its low-resolution (LR) counterpart, which has lost fine details due to downsampling or degradation. The degradation process can be mathematically expressed as:

$$\mathbf{y} = \mathcal{D}(\mathbf{x}) + \mathbf{n}, \quad (7)$$

where $\mathbf{x}$ denotes the original HR image, $\mathbf{y}$ is the observed LR image, $\mathcal{D}(\cdot)$ represents the degradation operator (typically involving blurring and downsampling), and $\mathbf{n}$ is the additive noise term. The goal of SR is to learn a mapping function $\mathcal{F}(\cdot)$ that reconstructs an HR estimate $\hat{\mathbf{x}} = \mathcal{F}(\mathbf{y})$ that approximates the ground truth $\mathbf{x}$ as closely as possible.

In our experiments, we simulate the low-resolution degradation using bicubic interpolation. Specifically, each image is first downsampled by a scaling factor $s = 0.5$, and then upsampled back to its original resolution using bicubic interpolation, following the process below:

$$\mathbf{y}_{\text{SR}} = \mathcal{U}_{\text{bicubic}}(\mathcal{D}_{\text{bicubic}}(\mathbf{x}, s)), \quad (8)$$

where $\mathcal{D}_{\text{bicubic}}(\cdot)$ denotes the bicubic downsampling operator with scale factor s , and $\mathcal{U}_{\text{bicubic}}(\cdot)$ denotes the bicubic upsampling operator to restore the original size. This process effectively removes high-frequency details and edge sharpness, simulating typical resolution degradation encountered in real-world scenarios.

3.5. Low-Light Image Enhancement Background

In real-world scenarios, images captured under insufficient illumination often suffer from low visibility, poor contrast, and severe noise amplification. Such low-light conditions may result from nighttime environments, backlit scenes, or limited sensor exposure, posing significant challenges for subsequent high-level vision tasks. The image degradation under low-light conditions can be approximately modeled as a linear attenuation of the illumination component:

$$\mathbf{y} = \alpha \mathbf{x} + \mathbf{n}, \quad (9)$$

where $\mathbf{x}$ denotes the original well-lit image, $\mathbf{y}$ represents the captured low-light image, $\alpha \in (0, 1)$ is the illumination attenuation coefficient controlling brightness reduction, and $\mathbf{n}$ is the sensor noise introduced or amplified in dark regions. A smaller α corresponds to darker illumination and more challenging restoration.

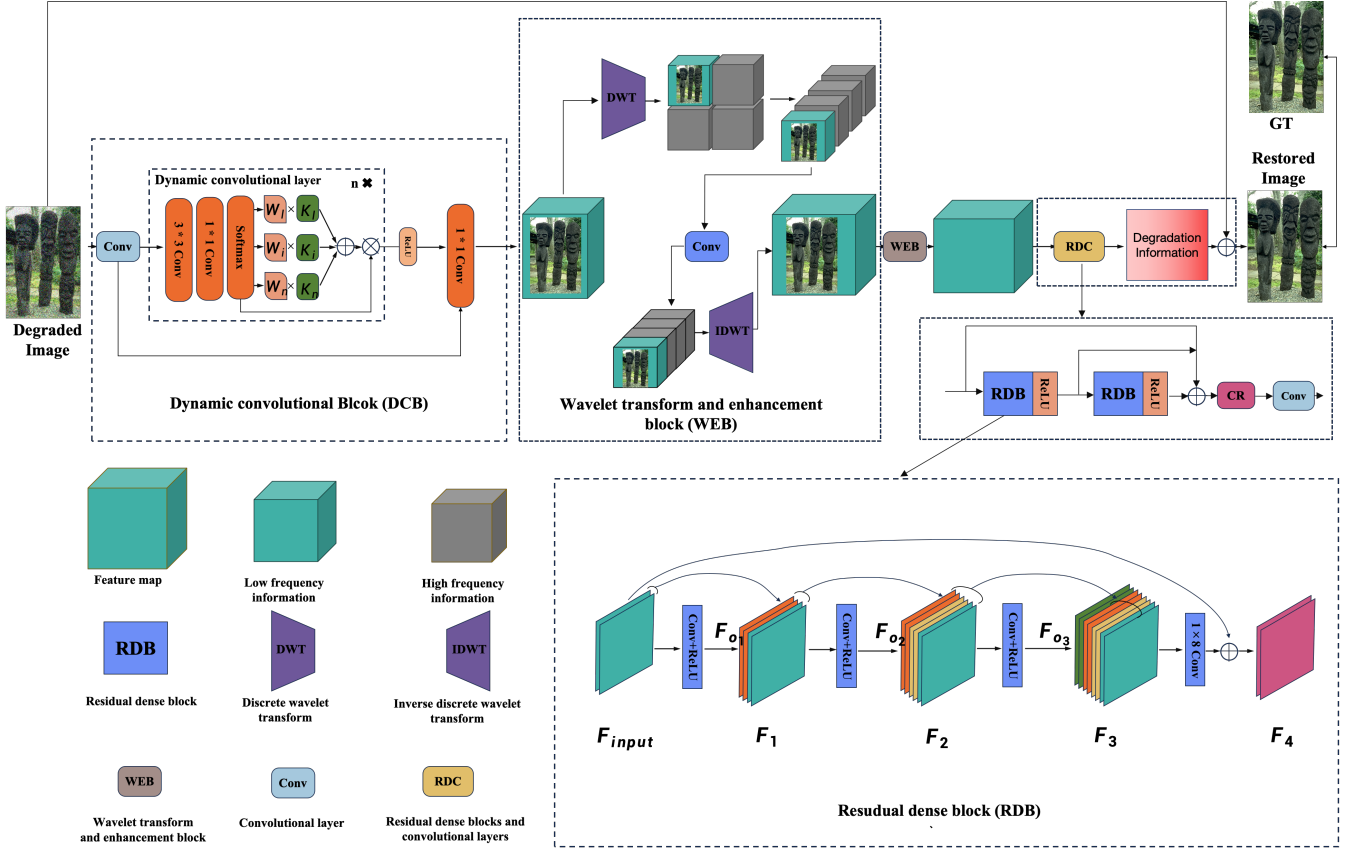


Fig. 1: Proposed Network architecture of MWRCNN.

3.6. Mixed Degradation Background

In real-world imaging systems, image degradation is often caused by multiple factors occurring simultaneously rather than a single isolated process. For instance, an image may be blurred due to camera motion, contaminated by sensor noise, and further compressed by lossy codecs such as JPEG. Such complex degradation scenarios pose significant challenges for image restoration models, as they require handling spatial, frequency, and compression artifacts concurrently.

To simulate these realistic situations, we construct a mixed degradation model that combines several common types of degradations, including Gaussian noise, Gaussian blur, JPEG compression, and bicubic downsampling. The overall degradation process can be mathematically expressed as:

$$\mathbf{y} = \mathcal{C}(\mathcal{D}(\mathcal{B}(\mathbf{x} + \mathbf{n}))), \quad (10)$$

where $\mathbf{x}$ denotes the clean image, $\mathbf{n} \sim \mathcal{N}(0, \sigma^2)$ represents additive Gaussian noise, $\mathcal{B}(\cdot)$ is a blurring operator (e.g., Gaussian blur), $\mathcal{D}(\cdot)$ denotes the downsampling operation (e.g., bicubic interpolation), and $\mathcal{C}(\cdot)$ represents JPEG compression with a specified quality factor.

This sequential degradation pipeline produces low-quality

observations that better approximate the complexity of real-world imaging conditions. The corresponding restoration task can be formulated as the following optimization problem:

$$\hat{\mathbf{x}} = \arg \min_{\mathbf{x}} \|\mathbf{y} - \mathcal{C}(\mathcal{D}(\mathcal{B}(\mathbf{x} + \mathbf{n})))\|_2^2 + \lambda \Phi(\mathbf{x}), \quad (11)$$

where the first term enforces reconstruction fidelity to the observed mixed-degraded image, and $\Phi(\mathbf{x})$ represents a regularization or learned prior that constrains the restoration process.

Compared with single-type degradations, this mixed degradation setting is more challenging, as it requires the model to learn robust representations that can adapt to different types and combinations of image corruptions. Therefore, we employ this setup to comprehensively evaluate the generalization ability of our proposed MWRCNN across multiple restoration scenarios.

3.7. Real-World Dataset Evaluation

Besides synthetic degradation, we also evaluate the performance of TV and MWRCNN on real-world datasets:

- **SIDD (Smartphone Image Denoising Dataset) [18].** SIDD provides real noisy images captured from various

smartphone sensors under diverse illumination conditions. Unlike synthetic AWGN, SIDD noise contains signal-dependent, nonlinear, and spatially varying components.

- **GoPro Dataset for Deblurring [19].** GoPro contains real-world and realistically captured motion-blurred images using high-frame-rate video. This dataset reflects natural camera shake blur, which cannot be fully mimicked by synthetic Gaussian blur.

These datasets allow us to assess the generalization capability of MWRCNN and the limitations of TV under truly complex degradations.

3.8. Evaluation Metrics

We employ both full-reference and no-reference image quality metrics to evaluate restoration performance.

Peak Signal-to-Noise Ratio (PSNR). PSNR is defined as:

$$\text{PSNR} = 10 \log_{10} \left(\frac{\text{MAX}_I^2}{\text{MSE}} \right),$$

where $\text{MAX}_I = 255$ and MSE is

$$\text{MSE} = \frac{1}{HW} \sum_{i=1}^H \sum_{j=1}^W (\hat{x}(i, j) - x(i, j))^2.$$

Structural Similarity Index (SSIM). SSIM measures perceptual similarity and is defined as:

$$\text{SSIM}(\mathbf{x}, \hat{\mathbf{x}}) = \frac{(2\mu_x \mu_{\hat{x}} + C_1)(2\sigma_{x\hat{x}} + C_2)}{(\mu_x^2 + \mu_{\hat{x}}^2 + C_1)(\sigma_x^2 + \sigma_{\hat{x}}^2 + C_2)},$$

where μ , σ^2 , and $\sigma_{x\hat{x}}$ denote the means, variances, and cross-covariance.

LPIPS (Learned Perceptual Image Patch Similarity). LPIPS measures perceptual distance using deep network features:

$$\text{LPIPS}(\mathbf{x}, \hat{\mathbf{x}}) = \sum_l w_l \|\phi_l(\mathbf{x}) - \phi_l(\hat{\mathbf{x}})\|_2^2,$$

where ϕ_l is the activation from layer l of a pretrained network and w_l are learned weights. LPIPS correlates strongly with human visual perception.

These metrics provide complementary insights: PSNR/SSIM emphasize pixel-level fidelity, whereas LPIPS captures perceptual quality.

For synthetic degradations and public real-world datasets that provide ground-truth references, we will report PSNR, SSIM, and LPIPS. For our self-collected real-distortion images without ground-truth, we will mainly rely on LPIPS and other perceptual quality scores to compare TV and MWR-CNN.

4. METHODOLOGY

4.1. Improvement on MWDCNN

This project is aiming to make improvement on 23-layer network for image denoising MWDCNN [7]. The network architecture is composed of three main parts: a Dynamic Convolutional Block (DCB), two cascaded Wavelet Transform and Enhancement Blocks (WEBs), and a Residual Block (RB).

4.1.1. Dynamic Convolutional Block (DCB)

The initial stage of the network is a 5-layer Dynamic Convolutional Block (DCB). This block utilizes a dynamic convolution, which is designed to dynamically adjust the parameters of several convolutions according to the specific content of different input images. The objective of this dynamic mechanism is to establish a trade-off between achieving high denoising performance and maintaining computational efficiency.

4.1.2. Wavelet Transform and Enhancement Blocks (WEBs)

Following the DCB, the data is processed by two stacked 8-layer Wavelet Transform and Enhancement Blocks (WEBs). These blocks are engineered to extract more useful information by synergizing signal processing techniques with discriminative learning. Specifically, they combine frequency features, obtained via the wavelet transform, with structural information captured by convolutional layers. This fusion allows the network to mine robust features essential for effective image denoising.

4.1.3. Residual Block (RB)

The final component is a 10-layer Residual Block (RB). This block's function is twofold: first, it refines the features obtained from the stacked WEBs using enhanced residual dense architectures. Second, it reconstructs the final clean image output by means of a residual learning operation.

4.1.4. Overall Improvement

The complete process, vividly showing the flow through these components, can be formulated by the following equation:

$$I_C = f_{RB}(f_{WEB}(f_{WEB}(f_{DCB}(I_N)))) = f_{MWDCNN}(I_N) \quad (12)$$

In this equation: I_N denotes the given noisy input image. I_C denotes the resulting clean image. f_{DCB} , f_{WEB} , and f_{RB} represent the functions of the DCB, WEB, and RB components, respectively. f_{MWDCNN} represents the overall function of the MWDCNN network.

4.2. Loss Function

To train the MWDCNN denoiser [7], in our reference work the mean square error (MSE) as the loss function, which is also treated as the objective function. This choice was made primarily to maintain consistency with other popular and established denoising methods, such as DnCNN [9] and FFDNet [20].

The training process is conducted in a supervised manner, utilizing pairs of clean and noisy images. These pairs are denoted as $\{I_C^i, I_N^i\}$, where $1 \leq i \leq n$. In this notation, I_C^i represents the i -th clean image, I_N^i represents the i -th noisy image, and n signifies the total number of noisy images in the training batch.

The optimization of the MWDCNN's parameters is performed using the Adam optimizer [21].

The MSE loss function is formally defined in the paper as follows:

$$l(\theta) = \frac{1}{2n} \sum_{i=1}^n \|f_{MWDCNN}(I_N^i) - (I_C^i)\|^2 \quad (13)$$

Where: l represents the loss function. θ denotes the parameter sets of the MWDCNN model. $f_{MWDCNN}(I_N^i)$ is the denoised image predicted by the network given the noisy input I_N^i . (I_C^i) is the corresponding clean ground truth image.

4.3. Approach and Work to be done

As we move forward with the design of the MWDCNN, the architecture of the Dynamic Convolution Block (DCB) is a critical component to finalize. This block serves as the first stage of the network, and its design will significantly impact the model's ability to adapt to varying inputs. We need to explore the following design considerations.

The primary discussion point is the block's role as the network's entry point. By placing the DCB first, we are tasking it with processing the raw noisy image directly. This strategy assumes the block can effectively sense the noise characteristics from the input and adjust its kernels accordingly. We should consider if this is the optimal placement, or if it might be more effective after an initial feature extraction layer.

The structure of the DCB involves a clear workflow. The design proposes a 5-layer composition, including initial convolution, 3-Layer Dynamic Convolution Core and final convolutional Layer.

The core of the dynamic mechanism is the Weight Generator (WG). This sub-module is responsible for generating the specific weights that are applied to the parallel convolutional kernels. This presents our most significant design trade-off.

The current work toward a very lightweight architecture: it uses an average pooling operation, followed by a couple of 1x1 convolutional layers and a Softmax.

For future works, now we learned that that the average pooling aggressively summarizes the feature map, allowing the WG to generate weights with minimal overhead. This fits the requirements with the block's goal of balancing performance and cost. However, in question on this simplicity, we find that average pooling discards all spatial information. We should consider the purely channel-based global descriptor enough for the WG to make an intelligent decision about denoising different parts of an image. In our future selection, a slightly more complex generator, perhaps one that preserves some spatial context, might yield significantly better adaptive performance, even if it adds a small computational cost.

Our next steps should involve targeted experiments to validate these design choices, especially the balance between the WG's complexity and its impact on denoising effectiveness.

5. EXPERIMENTS

5.1. Experimental Setup

To evaluate the proposed MWRCNN network under different restoration tasks, we conduct experiments on multiple synthetic degradation types. The experiments cover six representative low-level vision tasks, including:

- Image denoising with Gaussian noise ($\sigma = 25$ and $\sigma = 50$),
- Image deblurring using a Gaussian blur kernel (size 7×7 , $\sigma = 1.5$),
- JPEG compression artifact removal with quality factor $Q = 10$,
- Image super-resolution using bicubic downsampling with scaling ratio 0.5,
- Low-light image enhancement based on illumination attenuation,
- Mixed degradation combining blur, noise, JPEG compression and downsampling.

Following standard practice, clean images are taken from the dataset provided by Xu et al. [16] and corrupted using the degradation models discussed above. All quantitative evaluations are performed on the widely used BSD68 benchmark.

We compare our method against:

- Total Variation (TV) regularization — a classical inverse problem solver,
- MWDCNN — the original dynamic-convolution-based model,
- MWRCNN (ours) — the improved model.

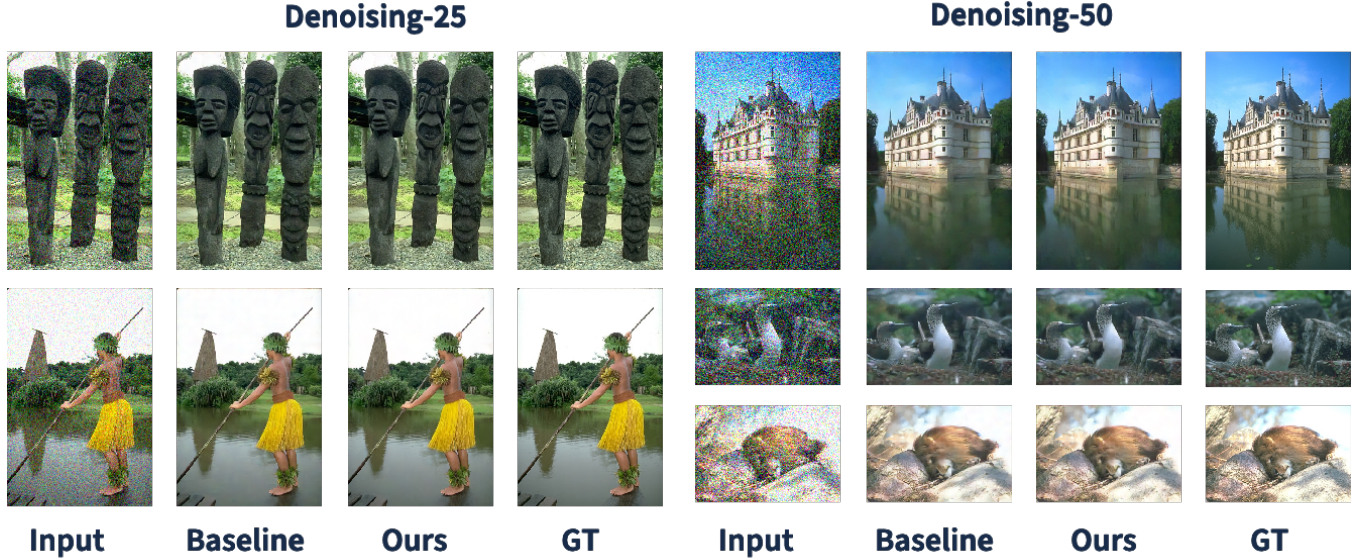


Fig. 2: Comparison of different methods on degradation scenes.

Performance is measured using Peak Signal-to-Noise Ratio (PSNR), Structural Similarity Index (SSIM), Mean Squared Error (MSE) and Learned Perceptual Image Patch Similarity (LPIPS), where PSNR/SSIM are higher-better, while MSE/LPIPS are lower-better.

5.2. Quantitative Results

Table 1 summarizes the results across all restoration tasks. Our proposed MWRCNN consistently outperforms both TV and MWDCNN. In particular, MWRCNN yields substantial improvements under complex degradation types, demonstrating superior robustness and generalization ability.

From Table 1, we observe that MWRCNN consistently achieves the best performance across all restoration tasks. Compared to the traditional TV model, MWRCNN yields significant improvements in PSNR, SSIM, and LPIPS, demonstrating clear advantages in both pixel-wise reconstruction accuracy and perceptual quality. For instance, under the denoising setting with $\sigma = 50$, MWRCNN improves PSNR by more than 3.5 dB over TV, while reducing LPIPS by more than 50%, indicating that the restored images preserve sharper textures and more natural details.

When compared to MWDCNN, MWRCNN provides stable and consistent improvements on all metrics. This demonstrates that the architectural modifications introduced in MWRCNN—including improved multi-stage feature extraction and enhanced dynamic convolution adaptation—contribute effectively to image restoration. The gain is especially noticeable in challenging settings, such as mixed degradation and low-light enhancement, where performance improvements exceed 0.02 in SSIM and more than 0.03 reduction

in LPIPS. These results confirm that MWRCNN generalizes better under complex degradation conditions.

Furthermore, MWRCNN delivers the highest perceptual quality with consistently lower LPIPS scores, indicating that the proposed method not only improves numerical accuracy but also produces images that better align with human visual perception. Overall, the reported results validate the effectiveness of our design and highlight the robustness of MWRCNN across diverse restoration scenarios.

5.3. Qualitative Comparison

To further illustrate the effectiveness of MWRCNN, we present qualitative comparisons against baseline methods across multiple degradation scenarios. Representative examples are shown in Figs. 2, 3, 4, covering deblurring, JPEG artifact removal, low-light enhancement, and super-resolution. Visual inspection highlights that MWRCNN reconstructs sharper structures, restores fine details, and reduces artifact patterns more effectively than competing approaches.

For deblurring, MWDCNN and TV tend to produce over-smoothed edges and residual blur, as seen in object boundaries and textured regions. In contrast, MWRCNN recovers sharper contours and richer texture patterns, closely resembling the ground truth. Similarly, under JPEG compression, baseline outputs contain noticeable block artifacts and ringing distortions, whereas our method suppresses these artifacts and restores smooth color transitions.

In the low-light enhancement setting, MWRCNN demonstrates clearer detail restoration and reduced noise amplification. Compared to MWDCNN, which retains visible sensor noise and unstable illumination, MWRCNN achieves more

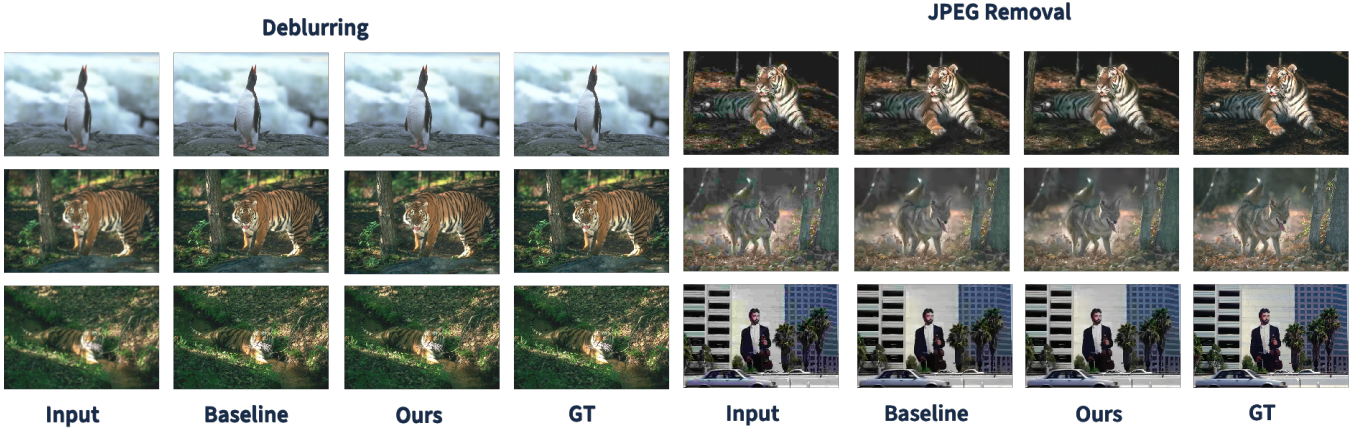


Fig. 3: Comparison of different methods on degradation scenes.

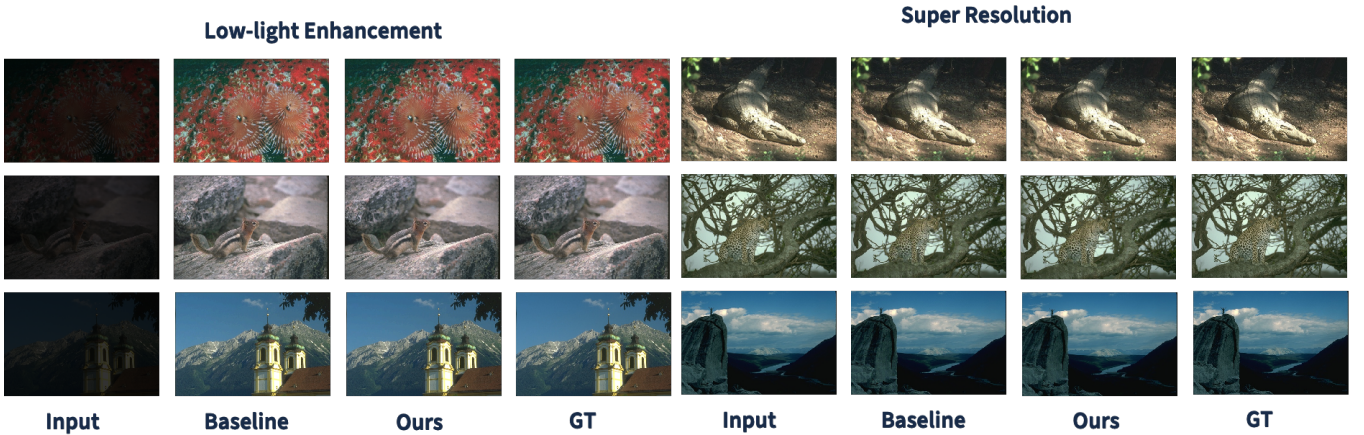


Fig. 4: Comparison of different methods on degradation scenes.

accurate tonal restoration and improved contrast, while preserving structural integrity in dark regions.

For super-resolution, MWRCNN generates sharper textures, particularly in high-frequency regions such as foliage and edges. Competing approaches either oversmooth such regions or introduce unnatural ringing artifacts. These observations align with our frequency enhancement design, which retains high-frequency cues through the proposed WEB modules.

Overall, qualitative results demonstrate that MWRCNN produces visually superior reconstruction, offering sharper edges, fewer artifacts, and stronger fidelity to ground truth. This performance advantage is consistent with the quantitative improvements observed in Table 1, confirming that frequency-domain refinement and dynamic feature adaptation lead to enhanced perceptual quality.

5.4. Evaluation on Real-World Datasets

In addition to synthetic degradations, we further evaluate MWRCNN on real-world restoration scenarios, using SIDD for realistic noisy image denoising and GoPro for real motion deblurring. Compared methods include classical TV, the original MWDCNN, and our proposed MWRCNN. Since real datasets contain signal-dependent noise and spatially varying motion blur, they represent a more challenging evaluation setting than synthetic noise and blur.

Table 2 summarizes the experimental results. On SIDD, MWRCNN achieves the highest PSNR and SSIM, outperforming MWDCNN by 0.30 dB and improving LPIPS by over 10%. For GoPro, MWRCNN demonstrates larger gains, improving PSNR by more than 0.5 dB over MWDCNN and significantly reducing LPIPS. These improvements verify that the proposed modifications enhance not only synthetic robustness, but also adaptation to real imaging pipelines, sensor characteristics, and real motion trajectories.

Overall, MWRCNN achieves consistently superior per-

Table 1: Quantitative comparison across different restoration tasks using PSNR $\uparrow$, SSIM $\uparrow$, MSE $\downarrow$ and LPIPS $\downarrow$. Best values in bold.

Task	Metric	TV	MWDCNN	MWRCNN
Denoising ($\sigma = 25$)	PSNR	25.2165	30.4581	30.8431
	SSIM	0.8324	0.8723	0.8799
	MSE	0.002348	0.000998	0.000921
	LPIPS	0.2165	0.0948	0.0765
Denoising ($\sigma = 50$)	PSNR	23.7475	27.1179	27.3188
	SSIM	0.6178	0.7650	0.7729
	MSE	0.008732	0.002193	0.002102
	LPIPS	0.4972	0.2315	0.2114
Deblurring	PSNR	27.6225	34.3098	34.6378
	SSIM	0.8360	0.9505	0.9519
	MSE	0.001056	0.000514	0.000472
	LPIPS	0.0651	0.0184	0.0161
JPEG Removal	PSNR	23.7529	26.9174	27.1212
	SSIM	0.7019	0.7730	0.7791
	MSE	0.006382	0.002404	0.002310
	LPIPS	0.4872	0.2483	0.2390
Low-light	PSNR	25.8526	35.7046	36.1740
	SSIM	0.7428	0.9888	0.9896
	MSE	0.001952	0.000329	0.000304
	LPIPS	0.0725	0.0156	0.0138
Super-Resolution	PSNR	23.8649	28.9314	29.2435
	SSIM	0.7924	0.8697	0.8769
	MSE	0.006382	0.001876	0.001778
	LPIPS	0.1928	0.0939	0.1007
Mixed Deg.	PSNR	18.2748	24.1724	24.5382
	SSIM	0.5698	0.6159	0.6372
	MSE	0.007839	0.004679	0.004395
	LPIPS	0.6782	0.4431	0.3944

Table 2: Quantitative comparison on real-world datasets using PSNR $\uparrow$, SSIM $\uparrow$, and LPIPS $\downarrow$.

Dataset	Metric	TV	MWDCNN	MWRCNN (Ours)
SIDD (Real Denoising)	PSNR	33.72	34.98	35.28
	SSIM	0.918	0.953	0.957
	LPIPS	0.1512	0.1248	0.1109
GoPro (Real Deblurring)	PSNR	26.81	29.02	29.58
	SSIM	0.842	0.909	0.918
	LPIPS	0.2114	0.1329	0.1184

ceptual scores and numerical fidelity across both real datasets. The results validate that MWRCNN generalizes better in uncontrolled imaging conditions, highlighting its applicability to practical deployment.

5.5. Ablation Study

To better understand the contribution of different architectural components of MWRCNN, we conduct an ablation study by progressively enabling the proposed modules. We start from a simplified baseline without dynamic convolution and wavelet-based frequency enhancement, and then incrementally add the Dynamic Convolutional Block (DCB), refined Weight Generator (WG), and the Wavelet Enhancement Block (WEB). We evaluate the variants under the denoising task ($\sigma = 50$) and mixed degradation, which represent medium and highly challenging conditions, respectively.

Table 3 summarizes the results. Without DCB and WEB, the baseline network exhibits notable degradation in perceptual scores, indicating that relying solely on fixed spatial convolution is insufficient to adapt to varying degradation pat-

Table 3: Ablation study under denoising ($\sigma = 50$) and mixed degradation tasks.

Model Variant	Task	PSNR $\uparrow$	SSIM $\uparrow$	LPIPS $\downarrow$
Baseline (No DCB / No WEB)	Denoise50	26.812	0.7424	0.2983
	Mixed	22.902	0.5933	0.5127
+ DCB Only	Denoise50	27.103	0.7598	0.2561
	Mixed	23.568	0.6049	0.4682
+ Improved WG	Denoise50	27.245	0.7686	0.2369
	Mixed	24.019	0.6181	0.4437
+ WEB Added	Denoise50	27.291	0.7719	0.2246
	Mixed	24.327	0.6297	0.4123
Full MWRCNN (Ours)	Denoise50	27.3188	0.7729	0.2114
	Mixed	24.5382	0.6372	0.3944

terns. Adding DCB improves PSNR and SSIM consistently, demonstrating that dynamic aggregation of multiple kernels enables better adaptation to content-dependent degradations.

Replacing the original lightweight WG with our revised generator further improves performance. This confirms that preserving richer spatial statistics within weight prediction leads to more appropriate kernel selection. When WEB is added, the model achieves a clear improvement in both fidelity metrics and perceptual quality. The gain is particularly strong under mixed degradation, where frequency-domain decomposition enables more accurate restoration of edges, textures, and compression artifacts.

Finally, combining all modules yields the complete MWRCNN, which shows the highest accuracy and best perceptual fidelity. These results validate our architectural design and indicate that each component contributes meaningfully to the final performance.

6. DISCUSSION AND FUTURE WORK

Although MWRCNN demonstrates clear performance gains across a variety of degradation types, several limitations remain that open meaningful directions for future extensions. First, while the dynamic convolution strategy enhances adaptability, the current implementation relies on a lightweight channel-based weight generation process. As discussed in our design analysis, such formulation may oversimplify spatially variant characteristics of degradation, leading to suboptimal kernel aggregation when local distortions are highly inconsistent. Future work may explore spatially aware or hierarchical attention mechanisms that preserve fine-grained contextual cues during kernel selection.

In addition, while the wavelet-based enhancement blocks improve high-frequency restoration, the fusion between spatial and frequency information is performed through fixed transform layers. This assumes that wavelet subband distributions remain consistent across tasks, which may not always hold, especially for real degradations where illumination variation, motion blur trajectory, and device-dependent noise introduce non-stationary frequency responses. Learning adaptive frequency transforms or integrating learnable

invertible transforms represents a promising alternative direction.

From a scalability perspective, MWRCNN is currently implemented under fixed-resolution settings and offline processing. Expanding the framework toward multi-scale training, streaming restoration, or computationally constrained deployment (e.g., mobile devices) would increase real applicability. Moreover, current evaluation is limited to synthetic degradations and two public real-world benchmarks. Additional validation on more diverse real-world datasets, such as low-light surveillance sequences, multi-sensor captures, and compression-based industrial data, would further strengthen the generalization claims.

Finally, an interesting extension is to incorporate task-aware parameter learning so that a single model could dynamically adjust restoration behavior without explicit retraining across tasks. Considering that MWRCNN already exhibits structural modularity, future work could exploit meta-learning or prompt-guided modulation to steer the restoration process depending on degradation estimates.

Overall, MWRCNN represents a solid step toward unified low-level restoration, and future improvements in degradation modeling, adaptive design, and scalable deployment are expected to further broaden its effectiveness in real imaging systems and downstream applications.

7. CONCLUSION

In this work, we extend the original MWDCNN architecture into a more general restoration framework, termed MWR-CNN, and demonstrate its effectiveness across a wide range of degradation scenarios. By integrating an improved dynamic convolution strategy and multi-stage wavelet-based enhancement, the proposed model achieves stronger adaptability to spatially varying distortions while preserving high-frequency detail. The ablation study confirms that each component, including the refined weight generation mechanism and wavelet enhancement blocks, contributes to steady improvements in fidelity and perceptual quality.

Experimental results on synthetic degradations show consistent gains over both traditional optimization-based approaches and the original MWDCNN architecture. Furthermore, evaluation on real-world datasets highlights the enhanced robustness and generalization capability of MWR-CNN, particularly under complex noise patterns and real motion blur. Overall, MWRCNN provides an efficient and scalable solution for general-purpose image restoration and establishes a foundation for future extensions in real-world imaging systems and downstream vision applications.

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